Nikolay Dychkov

Senior PHP / Symfony Backend Developer

nikolkady@gmail.com | Telegram: @ndychkov | ndychkov.com | github.com/Kolyn236

PROFILE

Senior PHP / Symfony Backend Developer with 9+ years of commercial backend experience. I build and evolve production services, REST APIs and integrations, and work with high-load systems, production incidents and complex legacy code. My strongest areas are performance engineering, code quality, incremental modernization and hands-on technical leadership.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Reduced execution time of selected data-processing operations by about 60% through database and processing optimizations.
- Reduced production container memory usage from about 4 GB to ~400 MB under comparable high load by introducing Memcached caching.
- Raised automated test coverage from about 20% to 80% across a set of production services.
- Raised the Mutation Score Indicator of a Symfony microservice from about 35-40% to 97% using Infection.

TECH STACK

Core: PHP 7-8.4, Symfony 3.4-7.4, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Memcached, RabbitMQ, Kafka, Doctrine, REST API, OpenAPI, Docker, CI/CD, PHPUnit, Codeception, PHPStan, SonarQube.
Additional: Laravel, Yii2, Slim, CodeIgniter, Elasticsearch, GraphQL, X-Cart, CS-Cart, WordPress, RAG, pgvector, AI-agent workflows, LLM-assisted development.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Engineer / Freelance - Senior Backend Developer

Jan 2026 - Present

- Build backend services and REST APIs with PHP 8 / Symfony, including architecture, API contracts, data models and external integrations.
- Designed and continue developing a multi-chain non-custodial application with separation between client-side code, business logic and infrastructure adapters.
- Built a RAG prototype with PostgreSQL/pgvector for semantic retrieval and grounded LLM context.
- Use Hermes, Codex and AI-agent workflows for codebase research, implementation, code review and change verification.

Stack: PHP 8, Symfony, PostgreSQL, pgvector, Redis, Docker, CI/CD, PHPUnit, LLM/RAG/AI Agents

ELAR Corporation - Lead Programmer

Feb 2025 - Jan 2026

- Designed a two-stage batch pipeline for large Excel imports: background processing, batched loading into PostgreSQL staging tables and distribution into target tables; supported tens of millions of records while controlling memory usage.
- Optimized data processing and database access, reducing execution time of selected operations by about 60%.
- Added PHPStan and SonarQube checks to GitHub Actions and local pre-push workflows; performed code review and made architecture decisions for complex backend tasks.
- Worked with Jenkins deployment pipelines and built a Docker image for reproducible local development.

Stack: PHP 7-8.3, Symfony 6.4, PostgreSQL, Doctrine, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, PHPStan, SonarQube

Source Code LLC - Senior Programmer

Feb 2023 - Feb 2025

- Supported around 7 production services, including releases, monitoring, incident investigation and service recovery.
- Introduced Memcached for repeated requests; Grafana metrics showed container memory usage dropping from about 4 GB to ~400 MB under comparable high load.
- Raised automated test coverage from about 20% to 80% with Codeception; participated in cross-team code review, onboarding and troubleshooting complex production issues.
- Built a base Symfony backend and integrated existing Docker images and CI stages for the production launch of the Leto v Moskve and Zima v Moskve city services.

Stack: PHP 7.4-8.3, Symfony 4.3/5.4/6.4, Docker, CI/CD, Memcached, Codeception, Grafana

Optimax Dev - Backend Developer

Apr 2022 - Mar 2023

- Integrated an external vision-assessment service: JSON API -> Symfony microservice -> database -> Magento Admin.
- Extracted functionality from Magento 1 into Symfony microservices and migrated three services from PHP 7.4 to PHP 8, including the move to PHP Attributes.
- Introduced mutation testing with Infection and raised one Symfony microservice MSI from about 35-40% to 97%; expanded OpenAPI/Swagger documentation.

  Stack: PHP 7.4-8, Symfony 5.4, Magento 1, PHPUnit, Infection, OpenAPI/Swagger, Microservices

Simtech - Software Developer

May 2019 - Mar 2022

- Implemented dozens of payment integrations for CS-Cart stores, including Stripe, PayPal, Nochex and custom providers: APIs, encryption and callback/webhook flows.
- Enhanced around 50 online stores and optimized 100k+ product catalogs through SQL tuning, indexes, temporary tables and reduced duplicate queries.
- Worked with QA to stabilize Codeception integration tests and helped teammates with the PHP side of test automation.

  Stack: PHP 5.6-7.4, CS-Cart, MySQL/PostgreSQL, Redis, Codeception, Nginx/Apache, Laravel 5.4

DaoTech - Software Engineer

Aug 2017 - Nov 2019

- Built Symfony 3.4 backend functionality for a vehicle CO2-emissions service: entities, CRUD/API endpoints, Doctrine migrations and Swagger/NelmioApiDocBundle documentation.
- Optimized legacy X-Cart stores through SQL/query tuning, index improvements and memory-leak investigation; worked across roughly 20 client projects.
- Created Docker configurations for local development and implemented GraphQL backend endpoints for integration with a React Native application.

  Stack: PHP, Symfony 3.4, Doctrine, X-Cart, GraphQL, MySQL, Docker, WordPress, Laravel, Slim, CodeIgniter

EDUCATION & LANGUAGE

Ulyanovsk State University - Faculty of Mathematics and Information Technologies, Specialist degree in Mathematical Support and Administration of Information Systems, 2014.
English: B2 - technical documentation, written work communication and technical discussions on calls.